Lesson 12: Unit 1 Review: Editing, Writing and a Self-Care Presentation

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 1: Academic Writing Essentials · Psychology

Adapted from High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0): 4.1: Exercise 12-Editing; 4.2: Exercise 13-Writing; 4.3: Exercise 14-Self-Care Presentation; Rubrics.

In this lesson

This lesson reviews the grammar of Unit 1: the simple present, simple past and present perfect, gerunds, infinitives and phrasal verbs. You edit a psychology student's summary paragraph, write two paragraphs about your own goals, and give a short talk about self-care to your tutor. Editing, writing and presenting are everyday tasks in a psychology course.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Find and correct errors in verb tense, gerunds, infinitives and phrasal verbs in a paragraph, and name the type of each error.
- Use Track Changes in a word processor to show your corrections.
- Write two paragraphs about your goals that use all six grammar forms of Unit 1 correctly.
- Plan, rehearse and record a 3- to 5-minute presentation about one self-care strategy.
- Score your own writing and speaking with the book's rubrics.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
simple present	base verb (the dictionary form), or verb + -s after he, she, it	"Someone feels the need to prove oneself."
simple past	verb + -ed or an irregular past form	"Last week, we studied paragraphs."
present perfect	have/has + past participle (the third form of the verb: studied, written, been)	"Chua and Rubenfeld have been criticized."
gerund	verb + -ing used as a noun	"...criticized for leaving factors out"
infinitive	to + base verb	"the way to be successful"
phrasal verb	a verb + a small word (up, out, off ...) with one meaning	"give up" = quit; "leave out" = exclude
Track Changes	a tool in Word or Google Docs that shows every change you make	"Copy and paste the passage into a word processing document and track the changes."

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
rubric	a table of the goals of an assignment, with points for each goal	"Unit Summary Writing Assignment: Exemplary 4, Satisfactory 3 ..."
superiority complex	the belief that you or your group is better than others	"...a belief that the individuals or groups are exceptional"
insecurity	the feeling that you are not good enough	"The second factor is insecurity."
grit	the strength to keep working hard for a long-term goal	"People with grit are willing to give it up for future success."
instant gratification	getting a pleasure or reward immediately, without waiting	"People naturally want instant gratification."
generational wealth	money and property that a family passes down from parents to children	"...factors such as generational wealth"
self-care	things you do to look after your own physical and mental health	"Research a topic on self-care."

Rules and explanations

Every error in Exercise 12 belongs to one of the grammar points of Unit 1. Here is a short summary of the book's rules.

Three tenses

Tense	Form	Use	Example
simple present	base verb; he/she/it: + -s, + -es/-ies, or irregular (has, does)	general facts, routines and habits, feelings, possessions	Yun-Ji has a car.
simple past	verb + -ed, or an irregular form (went, took)	a completed action in the past, often with yesterday, ... ago, last ...	Three months ago, Ayman visited Los Angeles.
present perfect	have/has + past participle	unknown time; unfinished and continuing now; repeated; expected but not yet finished; recent	Kyaw and Sunil have been friends for several years.

- Use **has** with a singular subject and **have** with a plural subject (two names joined by "and" are plural).
- "Be" is not a helping verb for the simple present: write "many psychologists agree", not "many psychologists are agree".
- With a finished past time (yesterday, last year, two weeks ago), use the simple past, not the present perfect.

Gerunds

A gerund is verb + -ing used as a noun. It can be:

- a subject: "Reading is fun." A one-action gerund subject takes a singular verb: "Spending too much money is not wise."
- an object after verbs such as avoid, consider, enjoy, finish, keep, practice, recommend, suggest: "Emily enjoys jogging in the mornings."
- the object of a preposition (in, for, about, of ...): "Jose is interested in reading that book."

Infinitives

An infinitive is to + base verb. It comes:

- after verbs such as agree, decide, hope, learn, need, plan, want: "Geraldo wants to transfer to a university."
- after adjectives: "It is important to wear a seatbelt."
- after nouns such as ability, chance, decision, goal, plan, way: "My goal to lose ten pounds is reasonable."
- to give a purpose: "I went to the store to buy the missing ingredients."

Phrasal verbs

- A phrasal verb is a verb + a small word with one meaning: give up (quit), leave out (exclude), put off (postpone), figure out (understand or solve).
- **Separable** phrasal verbs: a noun can go after the phrasal verb or in the middle ("Hyun-Ki gave up smoking." / "Hyun-Ki gave smoking up."). A pronoun (it, them, her ...) must go in the middle: "Hyun-Ki gave it up", not "Hyun-Ki gave up it".
- **Inseparable** phrasal verbs never separate: "I look up to my grandmother."

> **Note for Arabic speakers**
>
> - Arabic has no present perfect, so it is easy to use the simple past or simple present instead. Choose have/has + past participle for an unknown time or an action that continues now: "Chua and Rubenfeld have been criticized."
> - Arabic has no phrasal verbs. Learn each one as a single vocabulary item with its meaning, and practise the pronoun position: "give it up", "leave them out".

Practice

1. Exercise 12: Editing. Read the summary paragraph about success written by a psychology student (lesson material, 4.1). Identify and correct the errors related to verb tense, gerunds, infinitives and phrasal verbs. Type the paragraph into Word or Google Docs and turn on Track Changes, so that every correction shows (see Watch online). Then list your corrections and write the type of each error.

2. Exercise 14: Self-care presentation. Research a topic on self-care and give a 3- to 5-minute presentation about it to your tutor. Explain what the self-care strategy is and why it is important.

- (a) Choose one topic: Physical, Emotional, Spiritual, Personal, Work, Financial, Social or Intellectual.
- (b) Focus on one or two strategies under your topic. For example, for physical self-care you might describe sleep and rest; for emotional self-care, stress management. Use your psychology textbook or reliable websites.
- (c) Write an outline: what the strategy is, why it is important, and how to do it. Try to use this unit's grammar.
- (d) Rehearse two or three times. Record yourself with your phone and time the talk. Listen once and note your grammar errors.
- (e) Give the talk to your tutor in Live conversation, and ask for a score with the book's presentation rubric (below).

Presentation rubric (book): 4 (Exemplary), 3 (Satisfactory), 2 (Approaching Satisfactory) or 1/0 (Unsatisfactory/Incomplete) for each goal.

- The presentation includes the unit's grammar, and it is used accurately and appropriately.
- The content of the presentation aligns with the assignment.
- The presentation tool uses appropriate color, images, and font to enhance the content. (Only if you make slides.)
- The delivery of the presentation shows that the student has obviously prepared and rehearsed.
- It is free from spelling, punctuation, and general writing errors. (Check your slides or notes.)

Speak with your tutor

- "Here is my corrected paragraph from Exercise 12: [paste]. Which errors did I miss? Explain the rule for each one."
- "Give me eight sentences about psychology, each with one error in verb tense, a gerund, an infinitive or a phrasal verb. I will correct them."
- "I am going to give my self-care presentation now. Score me with the book's presentation rubric and list my grammar errors by type."
- "After my presentation, ask me three questions about my strategy, like an audience in a classroom."
- "Here are my two paragraphs about my goals: [paste]. Check the six labeled grammar forms and score me with the writing rubric."

Read aloud

Capitals show word stress; -ed endings are marked. In a phrasal verb, stress the small word: give it UP.

1. Amy Chua and Jed Rubenfeld state that suc·CESS is fueled /d/ by three factors.
2. The third factor is a char·ac·ter·IS·tic that Chua and Rubenfeld say is learned /d/: grit.
3. People naturally want instant grat·i·fi·CA·tion, but people with grit are willing to give it UP for future success.

4. Chua and Rubenfeld have been criticized /d/ for leaving factors such as gen·er·A·tion·al wealth OUT.
5. The way to be suc·CESS·ful is to de·VEL·op these qualities through self-DIS·ci·pline and de·ter·mi·NA·tion.

Writing task

Exercise 13. Write two paragraphs about your goals and the steps to achieving them. Write about only two goals, one in each paragraph. Goals may include these or other ideas: find a job, improve grades, meet new people, get into shape, learn a new skill, save money. Most of the sentences in each paragraph should be about the steps involved in achieving the goal.

- Length: about 8 to 12 sentences in each paragraph (the book gives no length). Word-process it and double-space it.
- Grammar: include each form at least one time: a) simple present, b) simple past, c) present perfect, d) gerund, e) infinitive, f) phrasal verb. Underline each grammar item and label it with the correct letter each time you use it, e.g. "I have saved (c)".

The book's writing rubric gives 4, 3, 2 or 1/0 points for each goal: the paragraph includes each of the grammar forms, underlined and labeled; the grammar forms are accurately and appropriately used; the paragraph is well developed and logically written; it is word processed and double-spaced; it is free from spelling, punctuation, and writing errors including comma splices and run-ons.

Self-editing checklist:

- Each paragraph is about one goal, and most sentences describe the steps.
- All six forms are there, underlined and labeled a) to f).
- After he, she, it or one thing, simple present verbs end in -s; "has" goes with singular subjects, "have" with plural ones.
- Finished past times (last year, two months ago) take the simple past; unknown or unfinished times take the present perfect.
- Gerunds follow prepositions and verbs like enjoy and avoid; infinitives follow verbs like want and decide, and nouns like goal and way.
- Pronouns go in the middle of separable phrasal verbs: "put it off".
- There are no comma splices or run-ons.

Paste your draft into the chat and ask your tutor for feedback. Then rewrite it.

Watch online

- How to track changes in Microsoft Word: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rznrpH-zQy4
- How to track changes in Google Docs: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X7yqViYSr74

Answer key

1. Exercise 12. The book gives no answer key. This guide counts six errors. Corrected paragraph (corrections in bold):

> Amy Chua and Jed Rubenfeld state that success is fueled by three factors that are a result of culture. Superiority complex is a belief that the individuals or groups are exceptional. The second factor is insecurity, which is when someone **feels** the need to prove oneself or that they are not good enough. The third factor is a characteristic that Chua and Rubenfeld say is learned: grit. People naturally want instant gratification, but people with grit are willing to **give it up** for future success. While many psychologists **agree** with these three factors, Chua and Rubenfeld **have been criticized** for leaving factors such as generational wealth out. Finally, according to Chua and Rubenfeld, the way **to be** successful is **to develop** these qualities through self-discipline and determination.

#	Error	Correction	Type and rule
1	someone feel	someone feels	verb tense (simple present): "someone" is singular (he or she), so the verb takes -s.
2	give up it	give it up	phrasal verb: "give up" is separable, and a pronoun must go in the middle.
3	are agree	agree	verb tense (simple present): "agree" is the main verb; do not add "are".
4	has been criticized	have been criticized	verb tense (present perfect): "Chua and Rubenfeld" is plural, so use "have".
5	the way be successful	the way to be successful	infinitive: "way" is a noun that is followed by an infinitive.
6	is develop	is to develop	infinitive: after "the way ... is", name the action with an infinitive. The gerund "is developing" is also correct.

Not errors: "for leaving" is a gerund after a preposition, and "leaving factors such as generational wealth out" is correct, because a noun can go in the middle of a separable phrasal verb ("leaving out factors such as generational wealth" is also correct).

Optional improvements (not verb errors): "**A** superiority complex is a belief that **some** individuals or groups are exceptional"; "to prove **themselves**" (to match "they").

2. Exercise 14. (example answer) Physical self-care: sleep and rest.

- Introduction: "I have chosen (present perfect) this topic because I did not sleep (simple past) enough during my exams last year."
- What it is: "Sleep gives (simple present) the body and the brain time to recover. Getting (gerund) enough sleep is one of the easiest ways to look after (infinitive, phrasal verb) your health."

- Why it is important: "Health experts recommend at least seven hours of sleep a night for adults. Without enough sleep, it is hard to focus and to remember new information."
- How to do it: "Try going to bed at the same time every night. Turn off your phone (phrasal verb) an hour before bed, and avoid drinking (gerund) coffee in the evening."

My notes